Mid Michigan College Board of Trustees Meeting Minutes

August 4, 2026

The meeting took place in the Community Room of the Mt Pleasant Campus at 5:30 p.m.

Board Present: Jane Zdrojewski, Board Chair; Dr. Karen Moore, Vice Chair; Nathan Weisenburger, Treasurer; Steve Wiesner, Secretary; Lois Pittsley, Trustee; Mark Jannott, Trustee; George Gilmore, Trustee

Also Present: Dr. Scott Mertes, President; Matt Miller, Vice President of Student Services & Advancement; Amy Fisher, Interim Vice President of Academic Services; Lori Fassett, Associate Vice President Human Resources; Ken Chinavare, CIO/ Associate Vice President of Technology; Alexa Carey, Executive Director Mid Michigan College Foundation; Hilary Breidenstein, Benefits Coordinator; Sherry Kyle, Executive Assistant to the President and Board of Trustees; Mr. Tim Odykirk, Candidate for Trustee on November 2026 ballot

CALL TO ORDER

The meeting was called to order by Chair Zdrojewski at 5:30 p.m. The Board Chair welcomed everyone.

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

Item II

A motion was made by Trustee Weisenburger, with support from Trustee Gilmore, to approve the agenda as reflected in the board packet. All ayes – motion carried.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

Item III

Board Chair Zdrojewski asked for public comment. Mr. Tim Odykirk of Mt Pleasant introduced himself as a candidate on the November general election ballot for one of the 6-year trustee terms. The Board Chair thanked Mr. Odykirk for his introduction and thanked him for attending the meeting this evening.

APPROVAL OF CONSENT ITEMS

Item IV

A motion was presented by Trustee Pittsley to approve the consent items this evening. Support by Trustee Weisenburger-all ayes; motion carried.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

Item V-A

Event Center Update

Vice President Miller provided an update on the Event Center project. Everything is going very well. He shared some recent photos of work that is done. The Open House and Ribbon Cutting for the Event Center is scheduled for November 24 at 3:30 p.m. A tour and introduction to the Center for employees takes place on October 21 – late afternoon. The Board Chair thanked Matt for his update. The Center is looking great.

Item V-B

Fall 2026 Enrollment Report

Vice President Miller shared the latest numbers for Mid's Fall 2026 semester. We have a healthy increase, with current sections filling fast and many new sections opening up. Final figures are reported in mid-September. The total number of credit hours taken by full time students continues to increase and is currently over 12. At one time it had reached an all-time low of being just over 7. This is good news. The information on fall enrollment is very good at this time in many ways. Miller will continue to report this information to the trustees monthly.

Item V-C

Mid Foundation and Capital Campaign Updates

Executive Director of the College Foundation, Alexa Carey, used powerpoint to provide an overview of the Foundation and the Capital Campaign. Since we have some fairly new trustees on board, the visual aid is helpful in understanding a brief history of the Foundation's purpose, activity, and membership. Alexa stated that Trustee Pittsley is the current Board of Trustees representative on the Foundation Board. She also shared that the annual Lakers Golf Outing is coming up soon on August 15. There is a full slate of 35 teams and many fun side events planned for the day. Trustee Pittsley commented that any size gift to the Foundation is greatly appreciated. Everyone should give at their comfort level. The Board Chair thanked Alexa for her Foundation update.

Item V-D

Board of Trustees Retreat Discussion

Board Chair Zdrojewski led a discussion on the agenda for the upcoming August 27 Board of Trustees Retreat. The event has been scheduled to take place in the Morey Tech Center at the Mt Pleasant Campus in Room 110 and the front conference room will be used for setting out the food. Agenda items will include:

- Strategic Plan
- Campus Master Plan
- Headlee Amendment with marketing plan information
- Annexation
- Future Trends – top 10 to impact Mid
- AI – In regard to students, employees, curriculum/programs (team for this item will be Trustee Weisenburger, President Mertes and Ken Chinavare)
- Board Operations
- How can we best support the new President?
- Partnerships – more to come on this topic – the Board Chair will provide additional information soon

Trustees with additional ideas and/or comments may send them to the Board Chair.

NEW BUSINESS

Item VI-A

President's Updates

President Mertes shared that this is his 35th day as the President of Mid Michigan College. He provided an overview of the many meetings that have taken place and some that are scheduled to take place soon. Connecting with legislators has begun, but with this being an election year, schedules are full. More to come as those take place. President Mertes is meeting with President Mackinnon of CMU tomorrow and is looking very forward to that. The CMU President has organized a group of community leaders, chamber members, etc. that will meet regularly for the betterment of the surrounding area. A meeting with McLaren health system takes place soon. McLaren's board chair is Dan Boge, one of Mid's generous donors. More to come after the meeting takes place. Dr. Mertes also informed employees of the college changes that are in place, and changes coming soon. It is hoped that early sharing of this information will be appreciated and be helpful to everyone's understanding of changes taking place. President Mertes also brought the board up to date on staffing updates that are currently underway. Opportunities for students were reviewed, including Dual Enrollment and Reconnect. The Board Chair thanked the President for his report.

Item VI-B

Truck Driving Blanket Purchase Order Request

President Mertes provided background information relating to Mid's Truck Driving program. Profits from the program are split 70/30 between Regen and Mid respectively. Autumn Matthews, Director of Workforce and Economic Development is requesting the Board approve the blanket purchase order at a total of $288,400. He also explained that since the Event

Center project construction began, the footprint of the work space needed did not allow enough space in the parking lots to hold the training at the Mt Pleasant Campus. It was moved to Freeland, but enrollment went down considerably at that time. Now that the program is taking place more locally again, enrollment has rebounded. It is hoped that a very suitable gravel lot can eventually be secured for use for best results. Trustee Gilmore offered a couple of suggestions that can be looked at for consideration. Follow-up on these areas will take place soon.

A motion was made by Trustee Gilmore, with support by Trustee Moore to approve the blanket purchase order for the truck driving program at a total cost of $288.400. All ayes – motion carried. President Mertes thanked the Board on behalf of Director Matthews.

Item V-E

Closed Session (Section 8.1.j of OMA)

President Mertes requested a closed session for the purpose of discussing his contract. A motion was made by Trustee Gilmore with support by Trustee Pittsley to go into closed session. Roll call vote showed ayes from trustees Weisenburger, Jannott, Pittsley, Zdrojewski, Weisner, Gilmore and Moore. The Board adjourned into closed session with the President and Ms. Kyle, Exec. Asst.

The Board re-convened to regular session at 7:45 pm.

Item VII-A

Calendar of Events

The Welcome Back Day for faculty and staff is scheduled for August 26 all day at the Mt Pleasant campus. There will be a Strategic Planning focus in the morning, with break-out sessions in the afternoon. Trustees are invited to participate or join for lunch if they are able. Ms. Kyle will send a calendar reminder for the event.

Item VII-B

Board Comments – Other Business

Trustee Pittsley asked how salaries balanced after all of the numerous vacancies are filled and the positions are filled, as compared to previous folks in the positions. Dr. Mertes shared that the numbers came out very close – in fact he believed that the final figures were less than break even. It all has worked out very well.

Trustee Moore is hosting a Capital Campaign event at her home in Beaverton tomorrow evening, August 5th. If you are able to attend, you are most welcome to do so.

Trustees Pittsley, Moore and Zdrojewski shared their experiences at the MCCA Summer Conference last week, as did President Mertes. The Board Chair encouraged all trustees to consider attendance next year.

President Mertes shared that soon postcards relative to the Headlee Amendment ballot issue will be sent. The official announcement of the Headlee Override on the ballot goes out this week. Trustee Pittsley shared that at the MCCA Summer Conference, the session on Headlee stated focus on community benefits from the college versus tax increase.

Trustee Jannott shared that he was glad to be at his first meeting of the Board of Trustees. He asked about the Strategic Plan and college Master Plan – and if these are available to look at. The Board Chair informed him that she will very soon be setting up an "onboarding session" with him, and provide all of the needed resources and folks that can assist in many different ways. It will be very helpful. Dr. Mertes informed the trustees that the last Strategic Plan had 30 departmental components that covered the many areas of Mid.

Board Chair Zdrojewski welcomed Trustee Jannott to the Board and stated that we are all looking forward to working with him.

The Board Chair will be contacting former Trustee Allen's daughter Marcy and wife Barb to attend an upcoming meeting and receive several gifts that honor Trustee Allen's many years of service. More to come.

Vacancies on Board Committees will be filled at the September Regular Board Meeting.

The meeting was adjourned at 7:09 p.m.

Respectfully Submitted,
Sherry L. Kyle
Executive Assistant to the President and Board of Trustees

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Jane E. Zdrojewski, Board Chair

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Steven T. Wiesner, Secretary